Edutechlife

MODULE 1 · ETHICS

Ethics of AI

Principles for using artificial intelligence with honesty, fairness and responsibility

Module 1
IALab · Edutechlife

Teaching guide 2026
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Using AI well is not only about getting good results: it is about knowing when to trust, when to verify, and when to say you used it. This guide gathers the principles that support responsible use at school, at work and in everyday life.

5
principles of responsible use

3
questions before publishing

1982
copyright law in Colombia (Law 23)

01 Why ethics matters in AI

An AI system can write something false with total confidence, repeat prejudices from its data, and produce content nobody signed. When we use it without judgment, errors multiply and the consequences fall on real people: a student wrongly accused, a client misinformed, or a decision taken on biased data.

02 The five principles

Transparency
Declare when you used AI and explain which part you reviewed yourself.

Truthfulness
Verify data, citations and names before using or sharing them.

Fairness
Check whether the answer treats every person with the same rigor.

Privacy
Do not share personal, minors' or confidential data.

Human responsibility
The final decision and its consequences still belong to a person.

03 Academic honesty

Using AI to understand a topic, organize ideas or check grammar can be a legitimate support, as long as the final text reflects your learning. Handing in work that you did not write or do not understand harms your education and misleads whoever evaluates it.

Acceptable use	Dishonest use
Asking for explanations and examples of the topic	Handing in an essay written entirely by AI
Checking the grammar of your own text	Presenting as yours a text you do not understand
Generating questions to study with	Answering an exam with answers generated on the spot
Declaring AI support in your work	Hiding AI use when the rules require disclosure

04 Bias and fairness

Models learn from data created by people, and they can repeat its inequalities: stereotypes of gender, region, age or socioeconomic level. Bias is sometimes not in what the answer says, but in what it leaves out.

1. Ask for the same task with different profiles and compare the answers.
2. Ask what perspectives are missing and look for at least one source that represents them.
3. Before deciding something that affects people, consult someone who knows the context.

05 Truthfulness and misinformation

AI can invent quotes, figures and references with total confidence. Misinformation is also produced with AI-generated images, audio and video.

BEFORE YOU SHARE SOMETHING

- Can I open the original source?
- Is the date recent and the author reliable?
- Does at least one other independent source confirm it?

06 Intellectual property and copyright

In Colombia, **Law 23 of 1982** protects the works of their authors. Using AI does not give you rights over other people's works: cite your sources, do not copy protected texts, and ask for permission when the use requires it. What you generate with AI must also be declared when it is published or handed in.

07 Personal data and minors

Law 1581 of 2012 regulates the processing of personal data in Colombia. Do not share third parties' data without authorization, and take special care with minors' data: it requires stronger protection and, for children and teenagers, the supervision of a responsible adult.

08 Decisions about people

AI can help organize information about people, but it must not make decisions that affect someone on its own: hiring, evaluating, sanctioning or diagnosing. Those decisions require human judgment, an explanation and the possibility of review.

09 Responsible use protocol

- [ ] I verified data, citations and names against the original source.
- [ ] I declared the use of AI where appropriate.
- [ ] I did not include personal data of third parties or minors without authorization.
- [ ] I checked whether the result treats all people fairly.
- [ ] A responsible person reviewed and approved the final decision.

TO WRAP UP

- [ ] I declare when I use AI and what I reviewed myself.
- [ ] I verify before sharing and I cite my sources.
- [ ] I protect personal data, especially minors' data.
- [ ] I keep a responsible person in every decision that affects others.